

an open approach in the cloud—supporting open standards and enabling open source on our cloud platforms. Support for Linux on Azure is a key part of this commitment towards openness. We aim to have broad and rich support for open source on our cloud platforms, and deliver great value for every IT dollar our customers spend.”

This initiative will also benefit Linux distributions that have joined hands with Microsoft. Naik explains, “For our partners, this clearly provides an expanded reach for their platforms through Windows Azure. And for Microsoft, these partnerships are invaluable in making the Linux experience we provide on Windows Azure today first class in every regard, in line with our commitment to openness. As part of the technical preview for Windows Azure Virtual Machines, key partners Canonical, OpenLogic and SUSE are expanding Windows Azure’s infrastructure-as-a-service capabilities by enabling Linux running on persistent virtual machines. Compatible operating systems and images available through the online gallery currently include: OpenLogic CentOS, openSUSE, SUSE Linux Enterprise Server and Ubuntu.” The kind of partnerships Microsoft has been able to strike clearly shows that its efforts have been well received by the Linux vendors.



Windows Azure™

It is worth mentioning here that the company had recently advertised an opportunity for a senior software engineer with hardcore Linux credentials. Commenting on it, Naik said, “Microsoft has worked hard to become even more open. We will continue down the path of openness by investing in open and emerging standards, and partnering with open source communities. Our partnership and investments in Linux are a core part of this effort towards being more open.” 

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